Community Budget Review Committee
Meeting Minutes

Wednesday, February 4, 2026
5:30pm - 7:30pm ~ Via Zoom

Presiding Officer: Adriel Person, Chair
Staff Support: Office of Family & Community Engagement, Office of Finance

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Committee Members Present:

Aaron Cronan	Anne Cherry	Julia Plowman	Rhonda Gray
Adriel Person*	Eli Posada**	Karanja Crews***	Shain Corey
Andy Jacob	Emma Lee**	Laura Hernandez	Shannon Staley
Angela Bonilla	Jen Gray-O'Connor	Minyana Bishop	Sirena Chen**
Anna Toll**			

PPS Staff and Board Liaison Present:

Alexandra Martin	Michelle Morrison	Patte Sullivan***	Tami Booth
Cheryl Pitman	Nichole Watson	Richard Smith	Terry Proctor
Jamaal Tibbs			

Committee Members Not Present:

Paxton Tomczyk**

* Committee Chair ** Student Member *** Board Liaison

Meeting Called to Order
The meeting was called to order at 5:33 p.m. by Chair Adriel Person, who welcomed members and invited Nichole Watson, Senior Director of Family & Community Engagement, to facilitate the meeting and guide the Committee through the agenda.

Welcome and Introductions
Nichole welcomed Committee Members and staff, noting that this was the first CBRC meeting of the year and the first meeting for several new members. Committee members (and staff) introduced themselves sharing their names, preferred pronouns and new or returning member status, as well as their connection to Portland Public Schools and an area of interest for this year.

Nichole acknowledged the scope and significance of the Committee's charge and reaffirmed the shared commitment to centering student experience while addressing fiscal constraints.

Housekeeping

Meeting Logistics

Meeting logistics and participation expectations were reviewed, including public meeting requirements and recognition that meetings are publicly noticed and recorded; procedures for public discussion; and methods for requesting staff follow-up outside of meetings.

Staff confirmed that all meeting materials will be distributed by email and posted publicly on the CBRC webpage. A structured process will be implemented to track Committee questions and staff responses. Cheryl Pitman was identified as a primary point of contact.

Meeting Schedule and Timeline

PPS Budget Manager Alexandra Martin reviewed the CBRC meeting schedule and major milestones, including:

- Monthly CBRC meetings through the spring
- A joint work session with the Board of Education
- Presentation of the Superintendent's Proposed Budget (anticipated April 28)
- CBRC work sessions to develop and finalize recommendations
- Presentation of the CBRC report to the Board of Education in May

Committee members were advised to review the schedule and plan for meetings where quorum and formal actions may be required.

CBRC Mission and Agreements

Nichole reviewed Committee operating expectations, including transparency, avoidance of conflicts of interest, respectful engagement across differing viewpoints, balancing individual perspectives with a system-wide lens, and supporting clear communication.

The CBRC's mission to review, evaluate and make recommendations to the Board of Education was discussed, as well as the importance of centering student voice and maintaining consistency with prior CBRC recommendations; it was also clarified that student members participate in an advisory capacity.

District Context and Alignment

Nichole shared an overview of the district's guiding framework, including Board of Education goals, the PPS ReImagined Framework, and the District Continuous Improvement Plan. The Committee's advisory role in supporting alignment between budget decisions and district priorities was reaffirmed.

CBRC Charter and Structure

Nichole reviewed the CBRC Charter, outlining:

- CBRC's advisory role to the Board of Education
- Membership structure and terms

Staff clarified that a quorum requires a majority of adult Committee members and that motions require a majority vote of the full Committee membership. In future, either the meeting facilitator or the Committee Chair will ask at the beginning of each meeting whether a quorum (one more than half) is present.

Reviewed CBRC leadership guidance and role of staff.Student members participate in an advisory capacity; consistent with Board practice, their votes are recorded but do not count toward official vote totals, which raised questions. **It was noted that any changes would require Board action**; **staff will look into this and report back to the Committee.**

Committee operating agreements were reviewed, including:

- Discretion and transparency
- Avoiding conflicts of interest or the appearance of such
- Balancing personal experiences with a system-wide perspective
- Engaging respectfully across differing viewpoints

Members emphasized the importance of student voice in Committee deliberations. Staff committed to returning with proposed approaches to further center student participation.

2026–27 Budget Context and Preliminary Information
Chief Financial Officer Michelle Morrison provided high-level background and context regarding financial pressures contibuting to the current shortfall, reduction targets and the budget development timeline.

Chief Morrison also presented preliminary budget assumptions and staffing recommendations, noting that the information being shared is preliminary and remains subject to refinement.

Richard Smith, Senior DIrector Research Assessment and Accountability and Tami Booth, Budget Director provided more detailed discussion of changes by grade level, clarifying and distinguishing school-based impacts from central office reductions including:

- Clear articulation of impacts on student experience
- Interpretation of staffing ratios, class size overages, and FTE calculations
- Anticipated use of attrition versus layoffs

Staff highlighted the fact that the recommendations are preliminary and that additional data, clarification, and noted that updated materials will be provided at future meetings.

Chief Morrison presented additional slides outlining preliminary central office services and support reductions, including both personnel and non-personnel impacts. She noted that while these reductions are to the central office, they may have downstream impacts on schools, and emphasized that the guiding objective is to preserve student experience. It was further clarified that reported FTE reductions reflect standardized staffing calculations and do not directly equate to the

number of individual employees affected, as impacts may include changes to schedules, assignments, or hours consistent with established human resources processes.

Engagement and Advocacy
Budget Director Tami Booth noted available resources, including information and resources for advocacy on PPS' Budget website:

- Budget Video Series
- Frequently Asked Questions
- Upcoming Engagement Events
- Advocate for Schools

Staff noted that the slides presented at the meeting would be emailed to the Committee members by Cheryl Pitman.

Video of this meeting is available for viewing at: https://www.youtube.com/live/UZ6jWhaJ6hg

Adjournment
The meeting was adjourned at 7:33 p.m.

Submitted by: Cheryl Pitman, Confidential Executive Assistant to the CFO
Next Meeting: Wednesday, March 4, 2026 5:30-7:30 p.m. (virtual)